Pegula Saves Match Point to Reach the Last Four

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Jessica Pegula saved a **match point** and fought into the last four of the **WTA Finals**. She beat Linda Noskova 7-6, 4-6, 7-5 in a match that went back and forth.

Pegula had to win. Coco Gauff had beaten Marta Kostyuk earlier on Thursday, so only a win over Noskova would carry her through.

Noskova went ahead in the third set and had a **match point** at 5-4 on Pegula's serve. But she could not take it, and Pegula held on to win.

Pegula's serve was the star of the show. She hit 16 **aces**, the most she has ever hit in a WTA Tour match. Noskova had trouble with her own serve, hitting 15 **double faults**.

Noskova had already made the **semi-finals**, where she will face Elina Svitolina or Aryna Sabalenka on Saturday. Pegula will play French Open champion Mirra Andreeva next.

Earlier, Gauff also fought back to beat Kostyuk, even after treatment on her lower back and going 5-1 down in the second set.

Word Treasure

match point -- A point that would win the whole match.
aces -- Serves that the other player cannot touch.
double faults -- Serves that go wrong twice in a row, giving the point away.
semi-finals -- The round before the final, where four players are left.
WTA Finals -- A big tennis event at the end of the season for the best women players.

Background you need

Tennis is a sport where two players hit a ball over a net with rackets.

The WTA Finals is a big event at the end of the season for the best women tennis players of the year.

A match point is a point that would win the whole match, so saving one means staying alive when defeat is one point away.

Break it down

WHO: Jessica Pegula and Linda Noskova
WHAT: A tennis match at the WTA Finals
WHERE: At the WTA Finals
WHY: Pegula had to win because only a win would carry her through after Gauff's win

Why it matters

Saving a match point shows that you should never give up, even when you are one point from losing, which is a lesson for any game you play.

Test what you remember

1. Who did Pegula beat?

(A) Marta Kostyuk
(B) Coco Gauff
(C) Linda Noskova
(D) Mirra Andreeva

2. What was the score?

(A) 7-6, 4-6, 7-5
(B) 7-5, 7-5
(C) 6-3, 6-1
(D) 6-0, 6-0

3. How many aces did Pegula hit?

(A) 6
(B) 9
(C) 15
(D) 16

4. How many double faults did Noskova hit?

(A) 9
(B) 5
(C) 15
(D) 16

5. Who will Pegula play next?

(A) Elina Svitolina
(B) Mirra Andreeva
(C) Marta Kostyuk
(D) Aryna Sabalenka

6. How far down was Gauff in the second set before she fought back?

(A) 4-1
(B) 6-1
(C) 3-1
(D) 5-1

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: A 3: D 4: C 5: B 6: D

Questions to think about

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):